



Yahoo View launched

Yahoo View, an application that provides free video content from Hulu is now live.
<http://dgit.in/YahooVw>



WaveNet audio

Google's DeepMind is working on a new speech generator that sounds more natural.
<http://dgit.in/WvNtAud>

THE INTERNET UNLEASHED

With the arrival of high speed internet and communication network, malicious software no longer relied on floppy disks or internal networks in organisations. It found a new favorite medium - email. Two of the most effective viruses to do this were the Melissa virus 1999 and the ILOVEYOU virus a year later. The Melissa virus took advantage of Visual Basic for Applications, that was built into Microsoft Word to create a word document which, when opened, immediately sent itself to the first 50 people on the opener's contact list. The ILOVEYOU virus was more human activated as it made no attempt to disguise its executable nature in the form of a .vbs file. And since the person received the message from someone on their contact list, with this name they were highly likely to open it. This virus has gone on to become one of the first documented examples of social engineering.

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LOVE-LETTER-FOR-Y
me. OU.TXT.vbs



THE THEORY AND THE FIRSTS

John Von Neumann discussed the possibility of a self replicating program back in the 1940's and published a paper on the same in 1966. The paper explored the idea of a mechanical organism being able to replicate itself and damage machines, much like a living organism. Creeper, often regarded as the first virus, was a test program created by Bob Thomas of BBN. While it did not have any malicious intent, it set the precedent for more such viruses to come. In 1974, the Rabbit virus was developed and released. It made multiple copies of itself on any machine it reached and significantly slowed down system performance. The first reported Trojan, ANIMAL, was created in 1975 by John Walker. The first PC virus Brain began infecting 5.2" floppy disks in 1986. Although it had no malicious intent, it was the first stealth virus placed on the boot sector of floppy disks.

Computer viruses

Tracing the evolution of what's been making your computer sick for the past 30 years

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